



## STATUS REPORT

# Cameroon — digital transformation and data governance status report

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## ICT Infrastructure

### Connectivity

Cameroon went back to Beijing for its backbone in March 2026, [contracting a China Exim Bank loan of about 108.4 billion FCFA by decree n°2026/084 of 6 March](#) to finance Phase IV of the national fibre-optic network, [adding some 4,000 km to Camtel's existing 12,000 km](#). The state operator that owns that network barely exists in retail: [Camtel holds 2.67% of the mobile market against Orange's 50.08% and MTN's 47.2% \(March 2026\)](#), and its commercial weight rests instead on wholesale bandwidth and its control of the country's submarine-cable landing stations.

[About 75% of the population lives under a 3G or better signal \(2023\) and 41.9% of people used the internet \(2023\)](#), with the built infrastructure [concentrated in Douala, Yaoundé and Buea](#). What that means inside public institutions is starker than the headline rates: [only around 32% of health facilities have their own computers and 27% an internet connection \(2024\)](#). Camtel [operated around 180,000 fibre ports and offered 4G in more than 160 municipalities \(September 2025\)](#). On the Ibrahim Index, [Internet & Computers rose 12.9 points over 2014-2023 to 33.4 out of 100](#), the country's largest infrastructure gain and still 27th of 54, while over the same decade rated public satisfaction with infrastructure fell 22.0 points to 19.3.

The regulator [fined Orange and MTN in July 2025 over quality of service and regulatory breaches and inspected networks in Douala in April 2026](#). Access is simultaneously being narrowed by administrative means: operators were [ordered to block unregistered handsets by IMEI from 25 May 2026](#), and access was [restricted around the October 2025 election](#). Domestic traffic can exchange at [CAMIX, which has points of presence in Douala and Yaoundé](#). Cameroon is also [landlocked Chad's only submarine-cable entry point](#), though the N'Djamena–Nana-Mbére link between the two was still unbuilt in February 2026.

### Data Storage

Cameroon's sovereign-hosting ambition rests on a physical base its own government review calls unfit: [CENADI's three-year, 269-page study of the data-centre ecosystem, presented in May 2025, found the country's existing facilities to be small and uncertified, short of international hosting standards](#), and recommended action on certification, security, connectivity and energy efficiency. [Most Cameroon-linked data was still held abroad in 2025](#), and [no hyperscale cloud provider operates a region in the country — the nearest is Johannesburg, which serves Cameroonian workloads at latencies above 100 milliseconds \(2025\)](#).

The state's answer is Camtel's Zamengoe facility near Yaoundé, [presented as the national asset on which government data and digital sovereignty rest](#) (June 2026) and [hosting for government agencies and businesses by December 2025](#). Alongside it, the Douala operator ST Digital runs a Tier-3 facility and is the sovereign-cloud partner [named for the national AI programme](#), the Minister of Posts and Telecommunications having visited it in July 2025; it also operates data centres in neighbouring markets and [positions itself as an African-owned alternative to the foreign hyperscalers](#). A further data centre is [under construction in Douala](#) to hold electricity metering data, and the national identity database has run from the police directorate's own data centre since 1994.

What is missing is the layer above the buildings. [Cameroon has no shared government cloud platform available to all government entities](#) (2025), and no national government cloud strategy has been adopted. Camtel's December 2025 master service agreement with Ethio Telecom [includes a sovereign government cloud workstream](#), and in July 2026 the same operator [opened talks with Amazon Web Services on cloud, satellite and AI cooperation](#) — the sovereign build and the hyperscaler conversation running at once.

## Energy

Power failure is the ordinary condition of doing business in Cameroon: [93.3% of firms surveyed had experienced outages, averaging 10.4 in a typical month](#) (2024). That is the first-order constraint on the digital estate — [inadequate electricity supply and thin bandwidth are the principal problems in operating data centres in the country](#), on the ecosystem review presented in May 2025.

Reach has improved slowly and unevenly. [National electricity access reached 72% of the population in 2023, up from 71% the year before](#), but the gap inside that figure is about 70 percentage points: [95.8% of the urban population had access against roughly 26% of the rural population](#) (2023). Cameroon's [Access to Energy score rose 8.3 points over 2014-2023 to 46.7 out of 100, 22nd of 54 African states](#). Generation is unusually clean by regional standards: [renewables accounted for 73.2% of electricity generated in 2024](#), up from around 60-65% in 2020-2022. Tariffs were harmonised from November 2024 at 50 XAF per kWh for the first 110 kWh a month, rising in bands to 99 XAF above 400 kWh.

Distributed supply is being opened up rather than left to the utility. The Rural Electrification Agency is [rolling out off-grid supply across 166 localities in a first phase and 184 in a second](#), and in December 2025 the regulator [granted the first private-sector solar mini-grid authorisation, to REI Cameroon for the Voundou pilot](#). The 2040 AI roadmap [plans solar-powered edge computing nodes](#) to distribute processing capacity. The grid is meanwhile becoming a data system in its own right: [20,000 smart meters began rolling out in May 2026](#) under the electricity-sector recovery programme, with a Douala data centre being built to hold what they collect. Sector transparency lags the build: energy is [the weakest of Cameroon's environmental data categories on the Open Data Inventory](#) (2024).

## Technical Capacity

The government's own diagnosis puts dependence on foreign technology alongside missing specialised skills: the Minister of Posts and Telecommunications [named both among six binding constraints on AI adoption](#) in July 2026. The state's flagship system demonstrates the point — [the design, production and operation of the national identity](#)

card system sit with a foreign contractor under a long build-operate-transfer arrangement, the police directorate retaining institutional oversight only — and the identity programme as a whole is financed from external and private sources rather than the domestic budget, with its coordinating committee going inactive when donor funding lapsed.

The disciplines that let a state run systems it did not build are largely absent. Cameroon has no data quality framework for government information systems, no system for monitoring their uptime and no guidance for replacing legacy systems (2025). A government entity focused on GovTech exists, but no coordination body leads digital initiatives and no entity monitors what government spends on them, and there is no strategy, unit or private-sector collaboration on public sector innovation.

Where capability is being added, it is being added at the agencies rather than across the administration. The national ICT agency ANTIC is running a migration of the country's networks from IPv4 to IPv6 alongside its DNS security programme, with support from ICANN and AFRINIC (June 2026), and has extended digital transformation support to a majority of the country's councils (July 2026). The telecoms regulator received quality-of-service monitoring platforms in January 2026 under the World Bank-funded digital transformation programme, giving it its own measurement capability rather than the operators'. Outside the state there is a working developer community, visible through local meetups and Cameroon-based open-source groups, small against the scale of what the country proposes to build.

## Cybersecurity

ANTIC handled 32,500 cybercrime complaints in 2025, about 30% more than the year before, having reported identifying and blocking more than 19 million threats during 2024 and flagged at least 8,502 security vulnerabilities in Cameroonian systems since January 2024. The same agency operates the national Computer Incident Response Team and the national public key infrastructure, so incident response and the certificate authority underpinning trust in government digital services sit inside one body. That team took delivery of roughly FCFA 735 million of intrusion detection and prevention hardware and software on 20 January 2026, funded by the World Bank through the PATNUC digital transformation programme, and ANTIC also ran a cyber-risk workshop for fintech operators in November 2025.

ANTIC signed the [.cm](#) domain with DNSSEC on 8 April 2025 and presented it as an act of digital sovereignty, but adoption below the zone is thin: national DNSSEC validation stood at 56.60% in December 2025, leaving nearly half of national DNS traffic unvalidated. The agency's target of 98% validation and full RPKI adoption by mid-2026 was restated in June 2026 as full DNSSEC coverage by the end of the year. On the identity side, the system carries encrypted storage, AFIS deduplication and ICAO-compliant digital signature verification, and a January 2025 duplicate-identity clean-up included an inter-ministerial security review.

The largest sustained security spending is not defensive. The national intelligent urban video-surveillance system has drawn four successive foreign credits over eight years, the most recent authorised by presidential decree in December 2025. The framework governing all of it remains Law 2010/012 of 2010 on cybersecurity and cybercrime, which civil society organisations argue is being applied against freedom of expression rather than against crime.

## DPI

### Data Exchange

Cameroon has [no government interoperability framework](#) setting the rules for data exchange between state systems (2025), and what exchange exists has been built bilaterally, system by system. The business registration platform [exchanges data automatically with the Directorate General of Taxation](#), with integration to the social security fund CNPS and the trade register RCCM planned but not built (2024). Between the national identity system and the rest of government there is [no digital link at all](#): birth certificates presented for a card are checked by eye, and the inter-ministerial Infocentre meant to harmonise the registers was not operational (2024). The social registry is [not joined to the identity or civil registration systems](#) (2025), the [electoral register reaches no wider exchange](#) (2025), and the social insurance and pension system [exchanges data with nothing else in government](#) (2025).

Most of the core administrative systems the GovTech Maturity Index assesses in Cameroon are nonetheless recorded as exchanging data with other systems — over interfaces built with no framework governing any of them (2025).

The legal basis is still in draft. An e-government bill [discussed in November 2025](#) would create a general right of access to public information and place interoperability governance under a new body, GovTech Cameroun; it had not been enacted by the end of that year. The [national AI strategy of July 2025](#) calls for a government data lake and national interoperability standards. Underneath both, the state has [no data quality framework for its information systems, no monitoring of their uptime and no guidance for replacing legacy systems](#) (2025). Health is the sector with a real integration effort: DHIS2 carries routine health data and [openIMIS, adopted in 2023, was built to HL7 FHIR and linked to the CamerHealth beneficiary registry](#) (2025).

### Digital Identity and CRVS

Cameroon's identity credential passed into foreign hands in February 2025: the police force that issues it, the DGSN, [signed a fifteen-year build-operate-transfer contract with the German firm Augentic](#) and retains institutional oversight only. [Issuance began on 3 March 2025](#). The card [carries ten fingerprints and is deduplicated one-to-many](#); it meets ICAO Doc 9303 in TD1 format and is recognised across the CEMAC free-movement zone, though no agreement provides for cross-border electronic authentication. Financing is primarily external and private rather than budgetary.

The card is [compulsory from age 18 and closed to anyone younger](#). [Décret n°2025/059](#) requires online pre-enrolment before a physical appointment, sets issuance within 48 hours of validation and fixes validity at ten years; the same decree lets an application be [suspended where nationality is doubted or where it is a first application made after age 30](#), routing late applicants into discretion rather than the 48-hour path. The IDCAM portal charges 10,000 FCFA, about US\$16 (February 2025), a stamp duty raised from 2,800 FCFA and criticised by lawmakers including opposition members (2025). Around 82.8% of adults held a card, leaving some 2.5 million without (2024).

The card is [required to open a bank account, to register a SIM — capped at twelve per identity — and to draw Filets Sociaux transfers and CNPS pensions](#) (2024), and [to register and vote](#). There is [no portal on which a person can see or correct the data held about them](#); [idcam.cm](#) takes applications only, and [no standalone regulation of digital identity exists](#). A civil registration law enacted in December 2024 created a unique personal identification number

and gave digital civil-status certificates the same legal standing as paper, though that number is not yet joined to the adult identity system. Digital civil registration is still a donor pilot, a UNDP-BUNEC partnership having issued more than 50,000 digital civil-status documents across 26 Far North centres since 2020 (2025).

Three foreign vendors run the identity document stack between them: a German firm for the national identity card, a Luxembourg firm for civil registration, and an Ivorian group for consular documents and secure printing (2026).

## Digital Payments and Fintech

Cameroon's central bank, BEAC, joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in July 2026, carrying all six CEMAC states in with it — but the country appears in the PAPSS network only through its Extended Network, for inbound transactions, rather than as a full participant (2026). GIMACPAY has run continuously since July 2020 with more than 90 participants and cumulative transaction values above 600 billion FCFA (2025); BEAC owns 99.2% of its operator and settles through the SYGMA real-time gross settlement platform, and the scheme supports person-to-person transfers, merchant and business payments, cross-border transfers, salaries and government payments (2023). Cameroon had 30.9 million registered mobile money accounts, more than its adult population, and the largest such market in Central Africa (2024), while 59.6% of adults made or received a digital payment and merchant-payment use roughly doubled from a low base between 2021 and 2024.

Government is moving its own money onto the rails slowly. Decree No. 2022/8001 supplies the legal basis for electronic payment of taxes, customs duties and other state revenue, and a prime ministerial order of May 2025 made the Treasury's Tresor Pay platform compulsory for several departments collecting non-tax revenue. The first digital payments to people came through a COVID-era emergency cash transfer paid into mobile money accounts, which beneficiaries preferred to cash by a margin of 78% (2021). New entrants keep arriving: Flutterwave holds a BEAC payments licence through a partnership with Ecobank (June 2025), state operator CAMTEL has tied its Blue Money service to an alliance with Ethio Telecom (December 2025), and Visa is expanding card issuance with Afriland First Bank (March 2026).

Oversight is thinner than the plumbing. There is no payment-specific consumer protection regime: the national financial education committee offers general mediation (2024). GIMAC renewed its PCI DSS certification in April 2026; BEAC's accounts are independently audited and published (2026), though its payment services reporting is regional and never broken out for Cameroon alone. Refugee documents are legally good for a mobile money account under BEAC's electronic money rules, yet providers unfamiliar with them refuse registration, so access turns on case-by-case advocacy.

## Registries

Cameroon's registers are digital and nearly empty. The second General Business Census found only 62,902 formal, properly structured businesses — 14.6% of a stock of roughly 430,000 — with 97.4% of about 3.7 million informal production units absent from the trade register (2024). EasyBusiness.cm is a nationwide single window with the OHADA trade and personal property credit register digitised, and more than 25,000 businesses have registered through it. The tax register is likewise digital and nationwide, with online taxpayer identification since 2020, and

grew from 80,000 to 400,000 registered taxpayers between 2014 and 2024 against a population of around 28 million, even as personal income tax contributes about 1% of GDP (2025). It is also the only register tied to the identity system, and only for individuals: companies are keyed on their RCCM number instead (2025).

Land is the weakest. Around 85% of land is unregistered and fewer than 1,000 new titles are issued a year (2024); there is no nationwide digital cadastre, only a multipurpose pilot at Soa that had field-identified 20,000 parcels across 330 square kilometres by March 2026 and titling otherwise manual. Since 1 July 2025 a non-objection letter from the traditional chief has been required before registration can proceed, a customary gate on a state register. There is no official national address register.

There is no continuously updated population register separate from civil registration (2024). Birth registration completeness was last measured at 61.9% (2018); the great majority of roughly 2,350 secondary civil status centres still register on paper (2025), and digital certificates reach ten municipalities (January 2026). The registers can also certify people who do not exist: a 2024 pension-fraud case turned on more than 13,000 fake birth certificates. The electoral register has been biometric since 2012–13 and is continuously revised, and ELECAM is deduplicating roughly 8.2 million entries (2025). The Unified Social Registry, created in May 2022, began national rollout in August 2024 across 100 social centres but remains far short of its national target (2026), and is not systematically linked to the identity system, a continuing barrier to paying beneficiaries (2025).

## Sectoral management information systems

Declared dependent children on Cameroon's state payroll rose 55.3% in 21 months, from 594,728 in June 2024 to 923,307 in March 2026, after a February 2024 decree raised the monthly child allowance from FCFA 2,800 to FCFA 4,500. The biometric payroll-verification system running since early 2025 has flagged tens of thousands of public servants drawing undue benefits (June 2026). A human resources system runs across the public service with a self-service portal and exchanges data with other systems, payroll is linked to it, and HR records carry the national identity number (2025) – which social insurance and pension records do not, that system exchanging data with no other part of government.

On the money side, an integrated financial management system supports transaction processing and budget preparation but reaches central government only, and the treasury single account it supports is only partly used (2025). Revenue administration is being rebuilt: alongside a customs management system that exchanges data with other government systems and the tax directorate's TAS, GovIn, ATOM and FUSION suite, the finance ministry awarded a US\$4.7 million contract in April 2026 to build SIGIT, a KfW-financed integrated tax and revenue system designed to interconnect with customs, budget and treasury.

Sectoral systems mostly collect statistics. The national DHIS2 instance is an aggregate reporting tool fed by manually compiled returns, not a point-of-care system, with 45% of digital health platforms reporting interoperability problems with it (2025); working clinical tools exist as donor deployments – DAMA registers at 154 PEPFAR-supported HIV/TB sites, OpenMRS pilots, the BornFyne prenatal platform, against a strategy target of electronic medical records in 70% of facilities that rural services have not met. Education runs the same way: SIGE and STATEDUC aggregate centrally from paper school returns, and a new integrated SIGE launched in May 2025 federates the education ministries' data. In justice, 42 of 60 targeted court registries are connected to the RJ-Secure



network while rural police and gendarmerie posts keep case files by hand on paper *procès-verbaux* (2025). The employment fund's jobseeker database and SYSTAC for driving licences stand alone, and no farmer registry reaches a government exchange.

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

Cameroon has no national online public service portal or one-stop shop through which citizens and businesses can transact with the state, and no government job portal either (2025). What exists is sectoral. The tax directorate runs *impots.cm* and *otp.dgi.cm* for filing and payment, routed through *Tresor Pay* and accepting MTN Mobile Money, Orange Money, Campost, bank transfer and Visa (2026); a social insurance and pension portal is in use for both registration and benefits, and citizens are involved in designing its services. The clearest success is at the border: the biometric e-visa has been fully operational since 30 April 2023, covering application, payment and biometric enrolment, and has issued more than 540,000 visas in three years (May 2026). CAMCIS handles customs declarations, including the import duty assessed on every mobile device brought into the country (March 2026), and PROXIGAB launched in January 2026 for small enterprises and young entrepreneurs.

Procurement is the furthest ahead. The COLEPS platform was upgraded with a US\$12 million KOICA grant (June 2025), adding online contract signing, real-time monitoring and bank integration for bid securities, and procurement data is published to the Open Contracting Data Standard – the one substantial thing government does publish.

None of it is run as one government. There is an established state entity focused on GovTech, but no steering committee or council leading GovTech initiatives, and nothing monitoring digital spending across government (2025), and the GovTech and digital transformation strategy remains in draft rather than adopted. PATNuC, the US\$100 million World Bank-financed transformation programme launched in August 2023, has not established a data exchange layer. Local government is being brought in separately, through a Digital Master Plan adopted in July 2025 for the roughly 394 councils and ANTIC support reaching 230 of them (July 2026). Measured readiness is low – 0.45 on the UN E-Government Development Index, 141st (2022) – and Effective Administration scores 40.7 out of 100, 39th of 54 (2023). Citizens can lodge complaints and information requests on government platforms, but the state neither demonstrates acting on that feedback nor publishes any service standards such as response times (2025).

## Governance

### Legislation and regulation

Cameroon enacted two of the most consequential statutes in its digital estate on the same day, 23 December 2024: Law No. 2024/017 on the protection of personal data, the country's first comprehensive instrument of its kind, and a civil registration reform that gives digital civil status certificates the same legal value as paper ones and establishes a unique personal identification number.

What sits beside them is a set of holes that a year of activity has not closed. There is [no comprehensive standalone regulation of digital identity](#): the 2025 decree governs issuance of the identity card and nothing wider, and a World Bank diagnostic found the legal framework for digital identity inadequate. There is [no right-to-information law in force](#), with a draft in consultation as at 2025. And the national AI consultations identified [the absence of a settled legal framework for supervised use of artificial intelligence](#) as a central problem for the country (July 2025).

A draft e-government law discussed at a government workshop in Ebolowa in November 2025 would create a general right of access to public information and place interoperability governance under a new body, GovTech Cameroun; it had not been enacted by the end of 2025.

The binding regime is therefore mostly older law. Cybercrime rests on [Law 2010/012 of 2010](#), which civil society organisations argued in June 2026 is being applied against freedom of expression rather than against crime. The state's own records remain anchored in paper, the [Criminal Procedure Code of 2005](#) requiring judicial police officers to write up investigations in *procès-verbaux*. Where new instruments have been made, they have been fiscal ones: [Decree No. 2022/8001](#) established the legal basis for electronic payment of taxes, customs duties and other state revenue, and the IMEI-based collection of import duty on mobile devices rests on [Article 6 of the 2023 Finance Law](#), which the government presents as enforcement of an existing duty rather than a new tax.

## Strategies, plans and policies

The national artificial intelligence strategy was [presented in July 2025](#) as a settled framework for Cameroon's digital future; a year later, at the cabinet meeting of [30 July 2026](#), the Prime Minister instructed that it be completed, an implementation roadmap having been tabled at the same session. [Ten priority areas are now attached to the draft](#), among them a sovereign scientific database, a national high-performance computing centre, AI modules in training curricula, mobilisation of diaspora expertise, and adaptation of the legal framework for governance, sovereignty and data protection. None is funded or established.

Behind the AI work, the machinery is thinner than the volume of announcement suggests. The [GovTech and digital transformation strategy is planned or in draft rather than adopted](#), there is [no dedicated government entity for data governance and no data governance strategy or policy](#), and there is [no open source software policy or action plan for the public sector](#), nor any entity deciding on open source adoption (2025). The GovTech entity that does exist has [no coordination body above it and no entity monitoring digital spending across government](#).

Delivery documents that have been adopted are sectoral or local rather than whole-of-government: a [Digital Master Plan for local government, adopted in July 2025](#) across roughly 394 decentralised authorities, and a completed [government study of the data-centre ecosystem, presented in May 2025](#) to underpin a sovereign-hosting policy that has not yet been issued.

The stated posture is [controlled acceleration rather than open adoption](#), with the sovereignty case put in market terms – that otherwise other countries capture the market for data produced in Cameroon (July 2026). It is being pursued from a weak base: Cameroon scores [42.9 out of 100 for overall governance](#), 39th of 54 African states and [down 2.1 points over 2014-2023](#) while the continental average rose, and [scores below the African average on 71 of the index's 96 indicators](#) (2023).



## Regional collaboration

Cameroon's most consequential cross-border digital relationship is with Chad, which reaches the sea only through Cameroonian territory, and it is stalled. The two governments signed a [digital cooperation agreement in May 2025 committing to complete the Nana-Mbéré fibre section within fourteen days](#); the link was still unbuilt in February 2026, by which point the operators' memorandum meant to deliver it had been [suspended by Chad's regulator on digital-sovereignty grounds](#).

Payments cross the border more easily than fibre. The regional instant payment scheme [treats domestic and cross-border transactions within the CEMAC monetary union alike](#), giving Cameroon full regional reach, and the regional central bank's [accession to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in July 2026](#) extends instant settlement to all six CEMAC states, though operation across the zone is not yet complete. Identity travels less far: the 2025 card is recognised within the CEMAC free-movement zone, but no formal agreement provides for cross-border electronic authentication against it.

Where data goes is now a live regional question. The [Central African telecoms regulators' association](#), in which Cameroon's regulator participates, agreed in February 2026 that [non-geostationary satellite operators must keep citizens' data on the African continent](#) — an association position rather than national law, with no transposition reported. Technical alignment runs through the same channels, with the national ICT agency [migrating networks from IPv4 to IPv6 with ICANN and AFRINIC support](#) (June 2026), and the AI roadmap proposing a [Central African AI network and an export label for Cameroonian AI products](#), with no partner states named.

The wider integration position has weakened: [Regional Integration scored 37.4 out of 100 in 2023, 36th of 54 and down 1.6 points over the decade](#), in a country whose only regional economic community membership is ECCAS.

## Standards

Enforcement of service standards produced the period's largest penalty: in [July 2025 the telecoms regulator fined Orange and MTN a combined CFA 2.6 billion, about US\\$4.6 million at the time, for poor quality of service and regulatory breaches found in 2024 inspections](#). The regulator has since gained its own measurement capability, [receiving quality-of-service monitoring platforms in January 2026 under the World Bank-funded PATNUC programme](#), and [inspecting network quality and coverage in the field in Douala in April 2026](#). Separate [guidelines issued in November 2025 require telecom terminal equipment to be certified before it enters the market](#).

Inside government the picture reverses. There is [no interoperability framework setting the rules for data exchange between state systems](#), and [no data quality framework for government information systems](#), no monitoring of their uptime, and [no guidance for replacing legacy systems](#) (2025).

None of the seven core administrative systems assessed across the state — financial management, the treasury single account, tax, customs, human resources, payroll and e-procurement — has governance arrangements on record covering compliance, security and audit trails over its operations (2025).

Standards do bind where an external party sets them. Cameroon has a [unified budget classification and chart of accounts covering both central and sub-national government](#), and publishes [procurement data in line with the Open Contracting Data Standard](#). The identity card is [built to ICAO Doc 9303 in TD1 format with a machine-readable zone](#)

and biometric chip, and the regional payment switch renewed independent PCI DSS v4.0.1 certification in April 2026. Where compliance depends on domestic actors it lags: DNSSEC validation across the national internet stood at 56.60 percent in December 2025, and the government's own review found the country's data centres small and uncertified, short of international hosting standards.

## Data protection

Cameroon has a comprehensive personal data protection statute and no supervisor to apply it: Law No. 2024/017 was enacted on 23 December 2024, the country's first such instrument, replacing partial provisions in Law No. 2010/013, and the protection authority it provides for had not been established as at 2025, with nothing published on data protection complaints or regulatory performance.

The rights environment around it has deteriorated sharply. Personal Liberties fell 30.3 points over 2014-2023 to 26.5 out of 100, 39th of 54 and the country's fifth most deteriorated governance indicator of 96. Internet access was restricted around the 23 October 2025 election period, a measure characterised at a June 2026 digital rights workshop as breaching the ICCPR and the African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights, at the same meeting that criticised the use of the cybercrime law against expression.

Individuals have little practical purchase on data held about them. There is no citizen-facing portal through which a person can view or manage their identity data, the pre-enrolment site handling applications only, and identity and nationality disputes reach the ordinary courts under general jurisdiction rather than any mechanism dedicated to the identity system or biometric data. Meanwhile the state is expanding collection: a decree of 17 December 2025 authorised borrowing of more than FCFA 39 billion to finance an urban video-surveillance system.

Sectoral cover is thin. There is no payment-specific consumer protection regime: the committee established under CEMAC regulation offers general financial mediation, and mobile money users are left short of comprehensive disclosure, liability and dispute-resolution provisions (2024). In health, most practitioners surveyed in 2025 were unaware of any data-governance guidelines applying to their work.

## Public debate and participation in policymaking

Cameroon scores zero out of 100 on Freedom of Association & Assembly, the lowest of all its Ibrahim Index indicator scores and down 12.5 points over 2014-2023 (2023). Media Freedom fell 7.6 points to 40.4, and Freedom of Expression & Belief fell 13.4 points to the same score, and Deliberative & Participatory Governance stands at 22.1 out of 100, 49th of 54.

Digitally, there is nothing to participate through. Cameroon has no national platform on which citizens or businesses can take part in policy decisions, submit petitions or give anonymous feedback. It does operate platforms for complaints, suggestions and information requests about service delivery, but does not demonstrate acting on that feedback and publishes no service standards such as response times or procedures (2025). Nor is there a right-to-information law in force for anyone wanting the records to argue with, though accessibility and disclosure of public records have both improved from a low base over 2014-2023.

Of the four public service portals assessed in Cameroon, only the social insurance and pension portal involves citizens in the design of its services; the tax portal, the job portal and the central service portal do not (2025).

Debate happens anyway, and mostly outside state channels. The 51st plenary of the National Episcopal Conference voiced concern in June 2026 at the growing use of artificial intelligence and its effects on society, putting the Catholic Church into the AI argument; lawmakers including opposition members of parliament criticised the cost and procedural complications of the new identity card in June 2025; and the terms of the technology debate are being set publicly around whether AI is democratised or captured by a narrow set of actors. AI itself entered the October 2025 presidential campaign, with synthetic content in circulation.

## Inclusion

### Digital divides

Geography is where the divide is actually measured. The 2022 national ICT household survey put rural internet use far below the urban rate, with not knowing how to use the internet the barrier non-users cited most often. Electricity runs along the same line, rural access standing at a fraction of urban access in 2023. Mobile network coverage has risen since 2018 but remains concentrated in Douala, Yaoundé and Buea, with a rural connectivity component targeting unserved localities by 2028. The state's own machinery shows the same shape: the local-government digitisation programme's baseline finds most councils without structured computer networks and many without digitally trained staff (June 2026), and ANTIC has publicly urged North West councils to close a shortfall in functional websites (July 2026). The telecommunications minister counts the regional divide among six binding constraints on AI adoption (July 2026), and reporting on the 2040 targets flags limited connectivity, data-centre capacity and the rural-urban access gap as unresolved (July 2025).

The gender line is the one that is not measured: no Cameroon-specific measurement of the gender gap in mobile or internet access is published (2025). Policy has run ahead of the evidence — Germany funds a programme to 2026 addressing the position that women, particularly in rural areas, benefit too little from digitalisation, and the AI roadmap sets a target share of women among the specialists it intends to train by 2040.

Exclusion is also written into procedure. The identity decree routes late first-time applicants, and those whose nationality is doubted, into a discretionary suspension process rather than the standard one, and pre-enrolment must be completed online through the IDCAM portal, for a fee. Biometrics carry their own failure mode: voters were struck from the electoral register in 2024 after fingerprint-capture failures on ageing enrolment kits, and reinstated only after public outcry. Against that, the government offers freely available digital skills programmes to citizens and schools (2025).

None of the citizen-facing government platforms assessed in the 2025 GovTech Maturity Index offers universally accessible omnichannel access, and the feedback platforms carry no support for users with disabilities such as voice commands.

### Access to services

Cameroon scores 34.9 out of 100 on the Ibrahim Index's Equal Access to Public Services measure (2023), 32nd of 54 and essentially flat over the decade, while Equal Socioeconomic Opportunity fell 4.1 points to 26.1, 44th of 54.

Most routes to a service run through the national identity card, legally required to open a bank account, register a SIM and receive social protection benefits including Filets Sociaux cash transfers and CNPS pensions (2024). Adult coverage is incomplete and lack of a document is a barrier unbanked Cameroonians cite, the card is not free, and rated ease of obtaining an identity document sits among the country's worst-scoring and most deteriorated indicators (2023). Those with no birth record have a fallback: an attestation d'état civil issued after hearings before the administrative and traditional authority and two family witnesses. Downstream, social protection's registries are not linked to the identity system, and missing cards among the target population remain a barrier to beneficiary identification and payment (2025), and the programme has reached only a minority of poor households (2025).

Non-nationals' legal route does not reliably work. Refugees and asylum seekers hold UNHCR-recognised documents that are legally accepted for SIM registration and, under BEAC's electronic money regulation, for mobile money accounts, but some providers are unfamiliar with them and refuse registration, so access depends on case-by-case UNHCR advocacy (2019). Civil registration likewise bars neither refugees nor internally displaced people and is backed by targeted programmes, but completion stays low where the registration infrastructure is weak, in the Far North, North-West and South-West (2024).

Cost and language gate the digital routes: a basic mobile data bundle costs more than the UN Broadband Commission's 2%-of-income affordability threshold (2023), and some government websites are published in both English and French (2023). The offline route survives by default rather than design — most secondary civil status centres still register births on paper, with poor rural connectivity, low digital literacy and distance the standing barriers (2025). Newer gates sit in front of the old ones: land registration has required a non-objection letter from the traditional chief since 1 July 2025.

## Technology

### AI

Two years of national consultation have produced a 2040 AI roadmap and no AI anywhere in the state's citizen-facing services. The roadmap, built on seven strategic pillars and running to 2040, was presented in Yaoundé in July 2025 alongside a national strategy from the Ministry of Posts and Telecommunications whose data and digital infrastructure pillar calls for a government data lake, mass digitisation of public services and national interoperability standards. A year on the strategy had not been finished: at the cabinet meeting of 30 July 2026 the Prime Minister instructed that it be completed. Meanwhile no chatbot or AI-enabled discussion forum is used in any of Cameroon's citizen engagement channels (2025).

The chain behind the strategy is well documented and slow. The National Consultations on Artificial Intelligence of 25-26 June 2024 resolved that Cameroon should develop a national strategy; the drafting mandate went on public tender in March 2025 to Cabinet Danielle Moukouri, a Cameroonian digital-law firm; a second edition of the consultations opened in Yaoundé on 7 July 2025 under Minister Minette Libom Li Likeng, framed by its organisers as a sovereign platform for structuring the country's AI ecosystem. Delivery has since been handed to ST Digital (2025), and an AI-governance workshop for public administrations was held with the International Telecommunication

Union in February 2026 to feed recommendations into implementation. The roadmap itself proposes new governance institutions and a sovereign large language model trained to work in the country's local languages — proposals, not bodies or systems that exist.

What is actually running is private. Rail operator Camrail has put artificial intelligence at the centre of its safety and logistics operations, through the DIBIE and Digitrack systems (November 2025). The public argument about the technology has started ahead of the policy: the 51st plenary of the National Episcopal Conference voiced concern at the growing use of artificial intelligence and its effects on society (June 2026), putting the Catholic Church into the debate. On the ITU's AI readiness assessment Cameroon sits below the African average (February 2026).

## ICT Industry

The state buys its largest digital systems abroad rather than from the sector at home: the national identity credential runs on a fifteen-year build-operate-transfer contract with a German supplier, leaving the police force that issues the card with institutional oversight only (February 2025), and the rest of the identity document stack is contracted out the same way.

The domestic side of the sector is small but not absent, and its most prominent firm has taken the national mandate. ST Digital, founded in Cameroon, runs certified data centres across four countries and positions itself as an African-owned alternative to the foreign hyperscalers (May 2026), and has been appointed to lead delivery of the national artificial intelligence strategy (2025). Incumbents are being contested from below and from outside at once: local fintechs are competing with established banks for the international trade finance market (October 2025), while Flutterwave holds a BEAC payments licence covering Cameroon through a partnership with Ecobank (June 2025), giving a foreign fintech regulated access to the CEMAC payments market.

The market these firms sit in is concentrated and the rules around it have been getting worse, not better. Mobile is split between Orange and MTN, with the state operator's retail presence negligible (March 2026), even as the telecoms sector grew strongly through 2024. Cameroon's Business and Competition Regulations score fell 6.2 points over 2014-2023 to 48.7 out of 100, 35th of 54 African countries, within a business and labour environment sub-category that also fell. The state does not buy from its own sector by design either: there is no procurement policy prioritising bids from startups or small and medium firms (2025). Its regulatory reach over the operators is limited — the 25 May 2026 deadline for blocking unregistered devices passed unmet, with the Finance Minister still pressing operators to comply under threat of tax penalties in June 2026.

## Innovation ecosystem

The machinery for founding and growing technology firms in Cameroon is privately built and privately funded. The government has no strategy or programme to improve public sector innovation, no government entity focused on it such as an innovation lab, and no collaboration with the private sector on it, and it provides no financing to startups or small firms for innovation and has no policy to support govtech startups (2025). What exists instead is a hub network: at least ten Cameroonian hubs are members of AfriLabs, with focus areas spanning fintech, agritech, the internet of things and women's entrepreneurship, and ActivSpaces operating sites in Douala, Buea and Bangangté (2026).

The money behind them is thin. Startup funding rose sharply in 2024 but stayed far below the level associated with an established ecosystem, over a tracked base of fewer than a hundred companies. External capital does some of the work the state does not: the French seed fund Digital Africa is investing in the Cameroonian payments fintech Futa (February 2025). Cameroon ranked 123rd of 133 economies in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, in the bottom quartile.

Products are nonetheless reaching the market from the hubs themselves. KMR Start-up HUB launched Pyramid in June 2026, a Cameroonian suite of browser, e-mail and streaming services whose data is held on infrastructure inside the country, and a mobile-money treasury product for small and medium enterprises, Momo Helep, is on the market (June 2026), taking mobile money from consumer transfers into business cash management. The state's own contribution is a single platform, PROXIGAB, launched in January 2026 to support SMEs and young entrepreneurs. The barrier new entrants actually hit is the payments layer: a Cameroonian games developer has publicly argued that the payment aggregation monopoly threatens the country's digital economy after its definition of online games swept in video-game studios (February 2025).

## Geopolitics

### US / hyperscaler activities

CAMTEL opened talks with Amazon Web Services in July 2026, with the US Embassy present, on cloud, satellite and AI cooperation, at the same time as the state operator was building a sovereign national cloud of its own. In payments, Visa and Afriland First Bank agreed in March 2026 to expand card issuance and acceptance, setting a US card network alongside the mobile money, Blue Money, GIMACPAY and PAPSS rails that carry domestic and regional payments.

### China activities

Cameroon's national intelligent urban video-surveillance system has drawn four successive foreign credits totalling XAF 150.8 billion over eight years, the most recent authorised in December 2025, and Chinese banks financed it from the start. Phase I rested on a US\$41.78 million commercial loan from Bank of China, ratified by decree on 5 June 2018, which funded a DGSN contract with Huawei for 1,500 cameras across the ten regional capitals and seven border and coastal towns, 2,000 portable two-way radios and command centres, with the national centre inaugurated in Yaoundé in August 2019. A second Bank of China loan of US\$41.6 million followed on 15 May 2019 for Phase 2, 76.1% disbursed by the end of 2020, though as at February 2022 no implementation of Phase 2 had been identified. A third credit of XAF 32.8 billion from China Citic Bank was contracted on 2 December 2024.

The fibre backbone is the larger commitment. China Eximbank signed a US\$337.1 million preferential buyer's credit with MINEPAT on 8 December 2015 for Phase 2 of the National Broadband Network — 20-year maturity, five-year grace, 2% interest — on-lent to CAMTEL to pay a US\$396.6 million Huawei contract adding 3,000 km of fibre across 13 cities; it was fully disbursed by the end of 2020, with XAF 180.3 billion outstanding. Cameroon returned to the same lender by decree in March 2026 for Phase IV of that backbone. Government systems have gone the same way: a CNY 216 million concessional loan under a framework agreement of 22 September 2017 paid for a US\$33 million contract with Anhui YISHANG Digital Science for trade facilitation and electronic certificate verification, and ZTE



agreed a grant in December 2015 to build turnkey data centres in Yaoundé and Douala for the National Emergency Telecommunications Network. In April 2026 Douala City Council signed a memorandum of understanding with Huawei to digitise its land files and issue a digital certificate of possession.

Chinese lenders account for the majority of Cameroon's recorded digital-sector finance, and China Eximbank alone is its largest single financier.

## EU activities

Design, production and operation of Cameroon's identity card system sit in European hands: the DGSN signed a 15-year build-operate-transfer contract with the German firm Augentic in May 2024, having previously contracted the French supplier Gemalto, now part of Thales, and keeps institutional oversight only. The same pattern reaches revenue collection: in April 2026 the Ministry of Finance awarded a US\$4.7 million contract to an ARABSOFT, ORADIST, C2D and DBS consortium to build SIGIT, an integrated tax and revenue management system financed by the German development bank KfW on a 24-month timeline and designed to interconnect with customs, budget and treasury systems.

German development money also runs to smaller programmes: BMZ is funding a EUR 3 million programme from 2023 to 2026 to close the digital gender divide, which addresses women in rural areas benefiting too little from digitalisation, and funded a EUR 3 million project from 2015 to 2019, now closed, advising spatial-planning decision-makers on harmonised soil and groundwater data for the South West and North regions. A second loan of XAF 32.8 billion for Phase II of the urban video-surveillance project was authorised in March 2024 through Banco Santander in Hong Kong, after China Construction Bank Corporation withdrew from the financing in 2021. The French seed fund Digital Africa said in February 2025 that it would invest in the Cameroonian payments fintech Futa.

## India activities

No Indian-financed or Indian-supplied digital infrastructure was in place in Cameroon as at August 2026, and no bilateral digital agreement with India was in force.

## Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf state, sovereign fund or Gulf-owned company held a financing, infrastructure or operator position in Cameroon's digital sector as at August 2026.

# Capacity

## Literacy

Nearly half of Cameroonians who had never been online gave not knowing how to use the internet as their main reason, in the national ICT household survey that found 34.0% of people aged 10 and over had used it in the previous three months (2022), 48.2% in urban areas against 14.7% in rural ones. The barrier the survey picked out is skill rather than reach, and it sits on top of a school system whose measured performance has been going the wrong way.

Cameroon's [education score on the Ibrahim Index](#) stood at 48.0 out of 100 in 2023, 35th of 54 African countries and 6.5 points below where it was a decade earlier, with enrolment at 41.3 and quality at 47.2 both down over the period and only completion, at 55.6, improved. The same profile scores human resources in education — trained and qualified teaching staff — lower still, at 38.6 and 36th of 54 (2023), and falling across the decade. In the schools themselves, [very few public primary schools have computers](#), and ICT where it is taught is overwhelmingly theoretical for want of equipment (2024).

The state does [offer digital skills programmes free to citizens and schools](#) (2025). Around that, the education system's own records are still [aggregated centrally from paper returns sent up by schools](#), the digitisation that has reached pupils directly has arrived as a [student digital identity issued with a mobile operator](#) (June 2026), and financial literacy has [a platform of its own for comparing bank charges](#) (June 2025).

## Training and skills

Cameroon's draft artificial intelligence strategy sets a target of [60,000 trained AI specialists by 2040, 40 per cent of them women](#) (July 2025) — a number with no counterpart in what the state currently runs. For its own workforce, the World Bank's [2025 index records a government strategy for basic digital skills in the public service](#) that has not reached full implementation.

What officials actually receive comes as discrete events tied to particular systems: two sessions on the road-fund management platform, [in Garoua in April 2025](#) and [in Douala in July 2025](#), a [cyber-risk workshop ANTIC ran for fintech operators](#) in November 2025, and an [AI-governance workshop with the International Telecommunication Union](#) in February 2026. The gap that leaves is visible in local government, where the diagnostic behind the digitisation programme found [a majority of councils with no digitally trained staff](#) (June 2026).

The pipeline into that workforce runs through [a handful of universities with dedicated computer science and ICT departments](#) and an [active local developer community](#), neither of which the state meets on the way out: it [operates no job portal](#), so public-sector vacancies are not advertised or applied for through a platform of its own (2025).

## Research institutions

The institutions that would let Cameroon produce knowledge in computing rather than only consume it are still proposals. A National High-Performance Computing Centre, a sovereign scientific database on a dedicated national platform and a centre for digitising scientific and technical information are among the [ten priority areas attached to the national AI strategy](#) while it was still in drafting (July 2026), alongside [centres of excellence for AI](#) in the roadmap behind it.

What exists is teaching capacity: [several universities run dedicated computer science and ICT departments](#) (2021), among them the National Higher Polytechnic Institute at the University of Bamenda, the National Advanced School of Engineering at the University of Yaounde I with its EU-accredited MSc in computer science engineering, UCAC-ICAM, and the Catholic university institutes at Bamenda and Buea. The network connecting higher education was built on external finance, under a [Chinese government concessional loan for an E-National Higher Education Network project](#) with the Ministry of Higher Education.

## Digitalisation

### Rural digital data capture

Cameroon's rural counter is still a paper counter: the great majority of the country's secondary civil status centres [register births by hand](#) (2025), and rural police and gendarmerie facilities [record case files, complaints and incident reports on paper procès-verbaux, with no digital case management system or incident database at facility level](#) (2025) — across a force of [444 brigades and 160 posts](#) (2025).

What digital capture does exist outside the cities is donor-built and geographically bounded. UNDP and the civil registration office BUNEC have [equipped civil status centres in the Far North with computers, biometric kits, printers and dedicated software](#) (2025). In health, [electronic registers at PEPFAR-supported HIV and tuberculosis sites, electronic medical record pilots in the East and Centre regions and a prenatal platform in a handful of health districts](#) (2024) sit inside a network that is otherwise on paper, and the national digital health plan's [target for electronic medical records](#) has not been met in rural areas, where [few facilities have their own computer or an internet connection](#) (2024).

The substrate for capturing anything is thinner than the national coverage figure suggests. Mobile network population coverage rose from [75% in 2018 to 87.5% in 2024](#), but infrastructure remains concentrated in Douala, Yaoundé and Buea, and the rural connectivity component of PATNuC targets 328 unserved localities by 2028. [Rural electricity access](#) (2023) and [rural internet use](#) (2022) both run far below the urban levels, and the [Rural Electrification Agency's off-grid rollout](#) (2025) is the main thing moving against that.

The rural economy the data would describe scores comparatively well. Cameroon's Rural Economy sub-category stood at [63.8 out of 100 in 2023, 24th of 54 countries and up 1.6 points — its second best-scoring sub-category of sixteen](#). Within it, rural land and water access improved substantially over the decade to 2023 while rural market access moved sharply the other way.

### Digitalisation of sub-national government

The diagnostic behind Cameroon's local-government digitisation drive is that [68.5% of local authorities have no structured computer network and 57.8% have no digitally trained staff](#) (June 2026). That baseline was published alongside the launch of [DIGI-COR](#), a local-government digitisation programme carrying an announced envelope of CFA 92 billion and run separately from the World Bank-backed PATNUC project (June 2026), and it follows the [Digital Master Plan for local government adopted in July 2025](#), which covers roughly 394 decentralised authorities.

Support has reached most councils on paper without changing much on the ground. The national ICT agency ANTIC counts [230 councils reached with digital transformation support, about 64% of the total](#) (July 2026), yet in the North West only [48.6% of councils have a functional website](#) (July 2026) — a shortfall ANTIC has publicly told them to close.

The national systems mostly stop above the council. Cameroon's [integrated financial management information system is scoped to central government](#) (2025), even though the [budget classification and chart of accounts are unified across both tiers](#) (2025), so the plumbing for consolidating local spending exists while the system that would carry it does not. Digital government more broadly [runs at national level](#) (2023), with infrastructure concentrated in Douala and Yaoundé.

The registers councils depend on are being digitised piecemeal and locally. There is [no nationwide digital cadastre](#) (2026), only a multipurpose pilot in Soa commune and a memorandum to pilot digitised land procedures in Lékié division; Douala City Council [signed its own memorandum with Huawei](#) to digitise its land files (April 2026); and land registration now requires a [non-objection letter from the traditional chief](#) before it can proceed (July 2025). On civil status, councils have [begun routine issuance of digital birth certificates with the same legal worth as paper ones](#) (January 2026), starting from Limbe I, on a [UNDP-implemented, Denmark-funded system covering councils in the Far North, North West and South West](#) (January 2026) — against the weak equipment, thin connectivity and low digital literacy of the issuing councils themselves.

## Data

### National statistics

Cameroon's statistical system is better at publishing than at collecting: across [the World Bank's five Statistical Performance Indicator pillars](#), the sources of data are the weakest and the data products the strongest, with data use, services and infrastructure all in the middle band (2023).

The shortfall in sources is literal. [No agricultural census has been run in twenty years](#), against a business census inside the decade, and [no labour force survey in the past ten years](#), against two household surveys, one agricultural survey and three or more health and business surveys. [The most recent population census falls inside twenty years but outside ten](#), so the state plans on population figures more than a decade old (2023).

The institutional frame is newer than the data it governs. [Law No. 2020/010 establishes a National Statistical Information System coordinated by the National Institute of Statistics](#), running cross-sectoral databases drawn from administrative records held across government under the National Strategy for the Development of Statistics 2021-2030. Capacity is rising from a low base: [the Ibrahim Index puts the capacity of the statistical system at 39.7 out of 100 in 2023, 36th of 54 African states, up 4.8 points over the decade](#).

Administrative data is not yet a substitute for survey data. [The education ministries' management information systems aggregate centrally from paper school returns](#) (2024), the national DHIS2 instance runs as an aggregate reporting tool fed by manually compiled returns (2024), and birth registration completeness has not been re-measured by a nationally representative survey since 2018. Where administrative counts carry money, they have proved unreliable: [declared dependent children on the state payroll rose sharply after the child allowance was raised](#), and the Finance Ministry's verification census is finding forged and duplicate birth certificates behind it (2026).

Self-monitoring is partial: the financial management information system captures expenditure linked to the Sustainable Development Goals only in part, and non-financial performance indicators for only a selection of programmes (2025). Sector statistics are strongest where a regulator produces them — the telecoms regulator's 2024 market observatory puts sector revenue at CFA 1,022 billion, 3.16% of GDP, on 18% growth.

## Open data

There is no open data portal publishing government datasets for reuse in Cameroon (2025), and no policy or institution behind one: no government body owns data governance and no data governance strategy exists. The right to ask for what is not published is equally unsettled — no right-to-information law is in force, with a draft in consultation and nothing published on requests received or granted, and a draft e-government law discussed at a PATNUC workshop in November 2025 would create a general right of access to public information but had not been enacted by the end of that year. The records regime is improving from a very low base: the Ibrahim Index scores accessibility of public records at 29.9 out of 100 in 2023, 26th of 54, up 11.8 points over the decade, and disclosure of public records at 32.9, 29th.

Cameroon meets none of the sixteen transparency tests the GovTech Maturity Index applies (2025): nothing is published on cloud usage, interoperability compliance, public investment projects, digital skills results, digital transformation progress, data governance, data protection complaints, regulator or online service performance, right-to-information implementation, public sector innovation, startup support, government responses to citizens, or public service standards.

What does reach the public is uneven by domain rather than absent. On Open Data Watch's inventory (2024), balance of payments and government finance statistics score 7.5 out of 10 while international trade scores 4.5 and money and banking 5; food security and health facility data score 7, against 5 for gender statistics and education outcomes and 4.5 for reproductive health; and among environmental categories energy is the weakest at 4.5, against 7 for natural resources and 6.5 for pollution. The strongest single case is procurement: the e-procurement portal is in use and its data is published to the Open Contracting Data Standard (2025), the one domain where publication follows an international schema. Openness is otherwise promised rather than delivered — the 2040 AI roadmap commits the government to adopting an open data policy and building a state data lake (July 2025), neither of which is in operation.

## Use of satellite data

No national space or geospatial data policy had been adopted, and no national Earth observation programme was in operation, as at August 2026.

## Finance

### New investments

Cameroon's national intelligent urban video-surveillance system has drawn four successive foreign credits totalling XAF 150.8 billion over eight years, the latest a decree of 17 December 2025 authorising XAF 39.2 billion (about US\$66 million) from China Citic Bank. The series began with a US\$41.78 million commercial loan from Bank of

China, ratified by decree in June 2018, which paid for a police contract with Huawei covering 1,500 cameras in the regional capitals and border towns. A XAF 32.8 billion tranche was authorised through Banco Santander's Hong Kong operation in March 2024, and a third of the same size contracted from China Citic Bank that December.

Some 26 distinct commitments from thirteen financiers are on the record between 2015 and 2026, worth roughly US\$2 billion, mixing signed loans, approved facilities and pipeline money. Chinese lenders account for over half of that, with China Eximbank the largest single financier at around US\$870 million across five commitments, ahead of the World Bank at about US\$450 million. Connectivity takes the biggest sectoral share, roughly 60% across nine commitments, with the video-surveillance tranches next. Almost none is grant money: grants come to a few tens of millions of dollars across the whole record.

The largest single commitment is China Eximbank's US\$337.1 million (XAF 199 billion) buyer's credit of December 2015 for the National Broadband Network's Phase 2, on-lent to CAMTEL for a Huawei contract adding 3,000 km of fibre across 13 cities; fully disbursed by the end of 2020, with XAF 180.3 billion outstanding. Of live money, the World Bank's US\$100 million PATNUC project, running 2021–2027, is visibly spending — cybersecurity systems worth over XAF 735 million reached the national CIRT at ANTIC on 20 January 2026 — and CAMTEL raised a XAF 44.884 billion (about US\$75 million) syndication with Commercial Bank-Cameroun on 21 January 2026 for mobile network expansion. Korea's KOICA put US\$12.5 million into the upgraded COLEPS procurement platform (June 2025), the African Development Bank's US\$29 million facility through CCA-Bank part-funds telecom equipment imports (December 2025), and Phase IV of the fibre backbone was contracted from China Eximbank by decree in March 2026.

## MoUs and other agreements

Cameroon's most consequential digital agreement is with another state telecoms operator: CAMTEL's master service agreement with Ethio Telecom, signed in December 2025, sets up a sovereign government cloud workstream and a national cloud intended to carry digitised public services, alongside a strategic alliance to build out CAMTEL's Blue Money payments product. These are framework instruments rather than contracts, and that pattern holds across the rest.

Vendors reach the state directly at municipal level: Douala City Council signed a memorandum of understanding with Huawei on 28 April 2026 to digitise the city's land files and create a digital certificate of possession, an intention rather than a delivered system. In payments, Visa and Afriland First Bank are partnering to expand card issuance and acceptance (March 2026), putting a US card network alongside the domestic and regional rails.

Regionally, a digital cooperation agreement with Chad in May 2025 committed both governments to completing the cross-border Nana-Mbéré fibre section, and ST Digital, the Douala data-centre operator, signed a memorandum with Gabon's national IT agency ANINF on 9 July 2025 to extend its capacity into the sub-region. Beyond what is signed, Yaoundé pressed in Seoul in June 2026 for a deeper technology partnership with South Korea — a request made at a diplomatic meeting, not an instrument.



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